First News

23 Mar 2026

Employing Intelligent investing, a disciplined, long-term approach to wealth creation based on fundamental analysis, risk management, and emotional control.

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Global, Regional Markets

Dow, S&P 500, and Nasdaq posted their fourth straight weekly losses as U.S. stocks slid on Friday.

On Friday, U.S. Treasury yields climbed, pressuring rate-sensitive sectors like mortgage REITs.

- Inflation
- Oil prices above $100 per barrel Risk-off mood, but concerns over inflation and fiscal imbalances outweighed safe-haven demand for Treasuries, USD/PHP 60+

US stocks edged lower while Brent crude reached $110, driven by heightened Middle East tensions.

- S&P 500 futures facing their longest weekly losing streak since March 2025.
- Two-year Treasury yields rose to 3.85% and gold was poised for its worst week in a year.

Middle East tensions disrupted approximately 7.5% of global oil supply, pushing prices higher

- Gold and precious metals saw a rebound on March 20, with gold up over 1% to around $4,662 per ounce and silver climbing 1.21% to about $72.08.

Iran launched ballistic missiles at the joint US-UK military base in Diego Garcia on Friday, demonstrating a missile capability that goes beyond what Tehran was known to have possessed.

Oil prices are edging higher having fallen earlier too, with Brent back to $112/barrel. Gold is fluctuating and now back below $4,600/oz.

Iran has enriched uranium up to 60% purity, close to weapons-grade levels

Bitcoin is trading around $69,600-$71,100 on March 20, 2026, after rebounding from near $63,000 but remaining well below its 2025 peak of over $126,000

- BTC is testing resistance in the $68,500-$71,500 range, where short-term holders are at breakeven

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Asia-Pacific

	3/19/2026	3/23/2026	%Chg
Dow Jones	46,225	45,577	-1.40%
S&P 500	6,625	6,506	-1.79%
NASDAQ	22,152	21,647	-2.28%
PCOMP	6,055.45	6,018.00	-0.62%
NKY	55,239.00	53,372.00	-3.38%
SHCOMP	4062.98	3957	-2.61%
HSI	26,025.00	25,277.00	-2.87%
KOSPI	5925	5781	-2.43%
SENSEX	76,704.00	74,532.00	-2.83%
TWSE	34,348	33,543	-2.34%
ASX200	8640.64	8428	-2.46%
BURSAKLCI	1729.81	1720	-0.57%
JCI	7106.84	7106	-0.01%
STI	5002.17	4848	-3.08%
SET	955.82	953	-0.30%
VNINDEX	1713.83	1647	-3.90%

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Commodities - Metals & Agriculture

	3/19/2026	3/23/2026	%Chg
WTI Crude	99.67	98.23	-1.44%
Brent Crude	111.85	112.19	0.30%
Gold (Comex)	4845	4845	0.00%
Silver (Comex)	76.59	76.59	0.00%
Platinum Spot	2044.62	1928.6	-5.67%
Copper (Comex)	551.6	537.45	-2.57%
Nickel	7.7066	7.5848	-1.58%
Nickel Ore Phl 1.5%	80	80	0.00%
Nickel Ore Phl 1.8%	94.5	94.5	0.00%
Coal	139.35	146.5	5.13%
Corn	466	465.5	-0.11%
Wheat	608.75	595.25	-2.22%
Cocoa	3260	3255	-0.15%
Sugar	14.8	15.7	6.08%

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Strategy

Asia and Philippines

Overseas Funds Flow Thursday
3/19/26

Bought Equities
Thailand $6.09 m Malaysia $23.4 m

Sold Equities
Taiwan $2.88 billion
South Korea $1.39 billion
India $462.5 m Indonesia $40 m
Vietnam $32.5 m
Philippines $7.68 m

USD/PHP Day 58.782- 60.166

The Philippines' balance of payments deficit widened to $2.277b in February from -$373m in January,BSP

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DA MARKET SECURITIES

Philippines

Employing Intelligent investing, a disciplined, long-term approach to wealth creation based on fundamental analysis, risk management, and emotional control,

6018 -36.83 pts., -0.61%

Range 5,934.68-6,018.62

Breadth 61(+) 133 (-) 55 (unch)

Block Php1.905bn **Volume** 1.88bn **Value** Php10.1bn

Share buyback sm ict opm spmh meg

52wk H: opm sgp
52wk L: ab ali alter ara bdo bhi bloom c medic pal rcb rci sbs sevn sm tech ubp vlc

Overbought – none
Oversold – tech pal pha tugs ferro mbt bpi gtcap vlc rci fli pmpc ali sm

Active	Value
ICT	1250
BPI	661
BDO	582
ALI	574
MBT	574
PLUS	344
SMPH	304
AC	235
APX	234

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DA MARKET SECURITIES

Foreign Trade

NFB(S)	$7.656mn
Total Month FS	$7.201mn
YTD NFB	$217.709mn
FB	6,022,784,448.07
FS	6,483,158,983.55
NFB(S)	460,374,535.48
TOTAL	12,505,943,431.62

Foreign Funds Bought
cbc ew secb dhi ap mwc mynld scc sgp cnpf dnl fcg monde hi jgs ali rcr shng vreit ict mac ipo sti plus web pgold nikl ogp

Foreign Funds Sold
bdo bpi mbt pnb acen alter fgen mer shlph emi jfc rfm urc imi ac aev agi cosco dmc gtcap ltg sm smc apvi areit meg mreit pha rlc smph glo tel cnvrg ceb bloom mrsgi rrhi sevn ssi wlcon apx at px

10yr Bond	3/19/20...	3/23/2...	%Chg
PHL	6.748	6.822	1.10%
US	4.235	4.392	3.71%

Currency Pair	3/19/2...	3/23/2...	%Chg
USD-JPY	159.29	159.23	0.64%
USD-PHP	59.898	59.799	0.06%
USD-CNY	6.8917	6.9036	0.24%
EUR-USD	1.1492	1.1572	-0.35%

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

San Miguel eyes coal blocks offered in DoE auction

MREIT 13.50

- **MREIT — SEC Clears ₱16.2B Wave 4 Asset Infusion Ahead of Schedule**
- MREIT Inc. secured SEC approval ahead of its expected timeline for its Wave 4 property-for-share swap, covering nine Grade A office buildings in McKinley Hill, Taguig with combined GLA of ~165,500 sqm. The deal is valued at ₱16.2B — structured as a ₱16.03B property-for-share swap plus ₱187.5M cash.
- The nine buildings were 97% occupied as of end-2025, with over 80% of tenants identified as Global Capability Centers. MREIT's GLA expands 34% to 647,000 sqm, with income contribution recognized retroactively from January 1, 2026.
- Wave 5 is next — retail diversification targeting several mall assets for H2 2026, pushing GLA toward 750,000 sqm and the 1 million sqm target by 2027.
- **Analysis:** Ahead-of-schedule approval is a management execution positive — it accelerates income contribution and signals efficient regulatory handling. The retroactive income recognition from January 1 means the full GLA boost flows into FY2026 earnings from Day 1, an underappreciated near-term catalyst. The 97% GCC-anchored occupancy profile is among the highest quality income streams in the REIT space — long-lease, dollar-linked tenants. Wave 5 retail adds strategic diversification beyond offices. Key risks: rate hike environment broadly compresses REIT valuations, and Megaworld sponsor dependency remains a structural concern.

FDC 4.20

- **FDC (Filinvest Development Corp.) — Record FY2025 Net Income ₱15.0B (+24%)**
- FDC reported its highest-ever attributable net income of ₱15.01B in 2025, up 23.7% from ₱12.13B. Consolidated net income reached ₱18.88B (+20%). Total revenues grew 6.3% to ₱120.57B. Banking and financial services remained the primary contributor at ₱7B or 40% of the group's bottom line. FDC Utilities contributed ₱4.9B in net income (+14%) despite a 27% revenue decline due to weaker spot market activity — cost controls cushioned margins. The property business generated ₱4.6B (+21%), with residential revenues climbing 15% to ₱20.2B and mall and rental income rising 7% to ₱9.0B. EastWest Bank posted a record ₱9.2B net income, up 21%, fueled by consumer lending and deposit growth. Total assets grew 7% to ₱872B while net debt-to-equity stood at a conservative 0.36:1.
- **Analysis:** This is FDC's third consecutive record year — and critically, growth is broad-based, not driven by one-offs. EastWest Bank anchoring 40% of earnings is both a strength and the key rate hike watch point: near-term, a BSP hike is historically positive for NIM; longer-term, it pressures credit demand and asset quality. The power unit's ability to grow earnings 14% despite a 27% revenue decline reflects exceptional cost discipline. Property revenues growing on real completions (not just bookings) is a quality signal. FDC trades at a meaningful conglomerate discount given its consistent track record.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

SMC 69.96
SCC 30.00
MER 603.00

- **SMC / SCC / MER — San Miguel Formally Joins Semirara Coal Auction; Three-Way Race Confirmed**
- Representatives from San Miguel Global Power Corp. (SMGP) and its subsidiary Sual Power Inc. attended the DOE's pre-submission conference on March 19, confirming SMC's active interest in the Semirara coal blocks. Sual Power operates the 1,200MW coal-fired plant in Pangasinan — securing upstream coal for this facility is the primary strategic rationale. SMPC (Semirara) was also present and is seeking to retain the concession, while MGEN (Meralco) has earlier expressed interest in a minority SMPC partnership. Application deadline is April 28 and winners are expected by May.
- **Analysis:** The coal auction is now a confirmed three-way contest: SMPC (incumbent, deepest operational expertise), MGEN (possible minority partner with SMPC), and SMGP (standalone bidder with captive demand from Sual, Mariveles, and Masinloc plants). SMC entering directly — rather than partnering with SMPC like MGEN — raises the competitive stakes for Semirara. However, the DOE's stated evaluation criteria emphasizing technical capability over price heavily favors SMPC's 50-year track record on the island. The May award is the pivotal binary catalyst for SCC. For SMC, bidding participation confirms a fuel security vertical integration strategy regardless of outcome.
- Stance: MONITOR for SCC — contract uncertainty persists until May. SMPC's technical edge remains the strongest bid factor but is no longer uncontested. BUY ON WEAKNESS for SCC on clarity. SMC positive on strategic intent regardless of outcome.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

TEL 1,295.00

- **TEL / PLDT (via VITRO Inc.) — Partners with Bounty Fresh Group for Data Center and Supply Chain Digitalization**
- VITRO Inc., PLDT's data center arm, announced a partnership with Bounty Fresh Group Holdings Inc. — one of the Philippines' leading poultry operators spanning rearing, processing, and nationwide distribution (Chooks-to-Go, Bounty Plus). Bounty will colocate critical data and disaster recovery systems at VITRO Santa Rosa, with PLDT Enterprise providing end-to-end connectivity across Bounty's farms, plants, and distribution channels. Gadgets Magazine
- **Analysis:** VITRO continues to systematically build its enterprise client base across verticals — banking (BDO), microfinance (Cebuana Lhuillier), and now agri-food (Bounty Fresh). Each deal adds recurring, long-term colocation and connectivity revenue. The Bounty Fresh partnership is notable for its agri-food supply chain digitalization angle — a high-growth sector as food producers invest in real-time visibility. For TEL (PLDT), the data center segment is increasingly the most structurally sound growth engine, providing a meaningful offset to mobile ARPU headwinds and Konektadong Pinoy-driven competitive pressure. Not a near-term stock mover, but confirms the VITRO revenue growth trajectory.
- Stance: ACCUMULATE for TEL on weakness. VITRO's B2B data center expansion is a long-term earnings compounder within the PLDT group.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

WEB 11.96

- **WEB (PhilWeb Corp.) — Partners with Okada Manila for "OKADA PLAY" Online Gaming Platform**
- PhilWeb Corp. signed a partnership with Tiger Resort, Leisure and Entertainment Inc. (operator of Okada Manila) to launch OKADA PLAY, with PhilWeb providing a full online gaming platform solution covering gaming content, technology, customer service, and marketing support. This is PhilWeb's second major integrated resort client in under three months — following its January 2026 partnership with Hann Casino Resort in Clark. Shares rose 4.00% to ₱11.96.
- **Analysis:** PhilWeb is executing a rapid B2B gaming technology roll-up — FBM bingo network (February), Hann Casino (January), and now Okada Manila (March). Each partnership adds a distinct revenue stream with minimal incremental capital outlay since the platform and technology are already built. Landing Okada Manila — the Philippines' most prestigious integrated resort — adds significant brand cachet and access to a high-value player demographic. This B2B model is fundamentally less exposed to PAGCOR's e-wallet restrictions than DigiPlus's direct B2C approach. Key risk: further online gaming regulatory changes could affect OGP licensing broadly.

BSC 0.1170

- **BSEC (Basic Energy Corp.) — Signs EPC Contracts for 43MW Cadiz Solar Project Basic Energy Corp.'s subsidiary Basic Energy Cadiz 1 Corp. (BECC) finalized Engineering, Procurement and Construction agreements with Raynergy Engineering Co. Ltd. (offshore supplier) and TBEA Subic Inc. (onshore contractor) for the GEA-4 solar farm in Cadiz City, Negros Occidental. Early site works are set to begin immediately, keeping the project on track for targeted completion by end-2026. Total project investment is approximately ₱1.9B.**
- **Analysis:** EPC contract signing removes execution uncertainty — it's the critical gate between planning and construction. GEA-4 government offtake eliminates spot market risk and provides revenue certainty from commercial operations. The Visayas grid location is strategically sound given ongoing regional demand growth. Basic Energy's transformation from oil & gas to renewable energy adds a clean energy re-rating angle, though the stock is very thinly traded at ₱0.117/share. Best suited for speculative, small-position RE sector exposure.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

PTT 0.33

- **PT&T Corp. — Files Revised Rehabilitation Plan; Targets Return to PSE Trading**
- PT&T Corp.'s board approved amendments to its rehabilitation plan to address remaining financial obligations, authorizing management to finalize and file the revisions with the rehabilitation court. The company is also working to complete requirements for its return to trading at the PSE — suspended since December 2004. PT&T was incorporated in 1962 and now focuses on fiber broadband services for corporate and SME clients.
- **Analysis:** PT&T has been in and out of rehabilitation for over two decades. The revised plan filing is a procedural step — the real catalyst would be rehabilitation court approval and a confirmed PSE re-listing date, neither of which is yet disclosed. The ₱8.9B debt-to-equity conversion completed in 2023 materially improved the balance sheet, and the operating business (fiber broadband) is viable. However, the Konektadong Pinoy law (2025) introducing new competition into the telco space adds a strategic headwind. This is a binary, highly speculative situation.
- Stance: WAIT. Rehabilitation court approval and a confirmed PSE re-listing timeline are required before any positioning consideration.

PSE-INDEX STOCKS

PSEi

	3/18/2026	3/19/2026	%Chg
AC	523.00	514.00	-1.72%
ACEN	2.64	2.55	-3.41%
AEV	30.50	29.40	-3.61%
ALI	18.94	18.28	-3.48%
AREIT	39.30	38.30	-2.54%
BDO	122.00	121.50	-0.41%
BPI	100.00	99.00	-1.00%
CBC	68.20	67.50	-1.03%
CNPF	35.50	36.05	1.55%
CNVRG	13.00	13.24	1.85%
DMC	9.76	9.75	-0.10%
EMI	15.58	15.26	-2.05%
GLO	1610.00	1619.00	0.56%
GTCAP	563.00	535.00	-4.97%
ICT	685.00	700.00	2.19%
JFC	190.00	185.00	-2.63%
JGS	25.40	26.90	

PSE-INDEX STOCKS

PSEi

	3/18/2026	3/19/2026	%Chg
LTG	14.20	14.34	0.99%
MBT	68.45	64.35	-5.99%
MER	605.00	608.00	0.50%
MONDE	5.99	6.10	1.84%
PGOLD	39.80	40.00	0.50%
PLUS	19.08	18.26	-4.30%
RCR	6.95	6.75	-2.88%
SCC	30.00	30.00	0.00%
SM	637.00	628.00	-1.41%
SMC	69.10	69.20	0.14%
SMPH	19.64	19.50	-0.71%
TEL	1311.00	1300.00	-0.84%
URC	68.50	64.00	-6.57%